

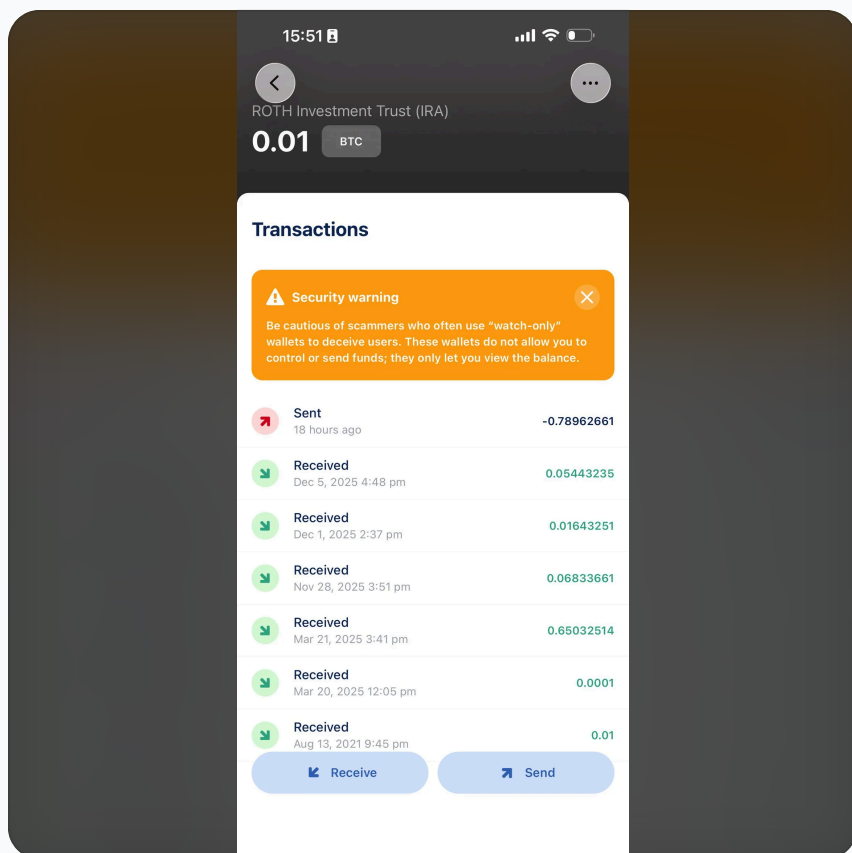


r/Bitcoin • 3d ago

s1ammage 🏆 Top 1% Poster



Wallet Drained Timeline



This is me...

<https://www.reddit.com/r/Bitcoin/s/UeSfLoeyS4>

I'm in a better state now. It's not the end of the world, but it's a lot of fucking money...

Little background: The setup was IRA custodian is Solera National Bank, exchange at Swan Bitcoin was used as an Investment Trust, purchase a dedicated hardware wallets: coldcard mk3 from <https://store.coinkite.com> May 2021 for this ROTH IRA.

Got the wallets, followed all the setup/checks/balances from https://youtu.be/FAYmE5-40PQ?is=wiYMHaS_YGKHjNOY for both wallets, sent a test transaction IRA dedicated hardware wallet (2021). I never setup a 25th Passphrase... REST of the BTC stayed in Swan Exchange.

Speaking only on this IRA Wallet: SD card stored with wallet details (paper phrase) in a baggie. Dormant until January 2025. I couldn't deposit more because of Roth IRA threshold.

Come January 2025, been learning more about retirement, BTC, multi-Sig, and heard about a Megaback Door to get more money into a Roth IRA. Was able to get money into Solera, transfer to Swan, and purchase more BTC and withdraw to the same wallet address. No new hardware involved at this point.

r/Bitcoin

Joined

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GUIDELINES

- Do not use URL shortening services: always submit the real link.
- Begging/asking for bitcoins is absolutely not allowed, no matter how badly you need the bitcoins. Only requests for donations to large, recognized charities are allowed, and only if there is good

2025)

For some reason, when I got the new coldcards, I never did anything with them for all of 2025, I guess I was too lazy/daunting to use the hardware and relearn. Coming to January 2026 now, I decided to use these new cards. I dug out the wallet seed (from 2021) phrase paper. Dusted off one of the mk4, walked into the corner of a room in my house (only myself and partner live in the house), plugged in the cold card into an outlet and typed in the seed written down from 2021 (stored in my dresser). Restored my 2021 onto one of the new wallet 2025.

Watched updated BTCSession videos on my phone to set everything up again. I never plugged into a computer, since airgapped was the reason I got the coldcards. I used the same SD Card from 2021 though to export the wallet file from the newly restored coldcard. Import that file into Sparrow (needed to update Sparrow at this point), generated a watch-only wallet QR (to scan for my phone) for Blue Wallet to check frequently. This is where the screenshot is from.

Honestly, I haven't touched the wallet with any transactions/seeds since January 2026. This is definitely the point of failure when I restored the 2021 wallet (now on 2 devices).

This was the transaction.
<https://mempool.space/tx/2fe075cf0ec799f3529ed6a28e0a08b45fe1fc9bd93c3f33bdbc42d5bff4f736>

My wallet address is (with all transactions, since it's gone now...):
bc1qldkfrlylk4s9sdyns9jkaajuzugl0dv5m8fxj

My key takeaway now never enter the seed phrase into anything. EVER. Even to restore. Always will generate new and use a 25th passphrase.

↑ 686 ↓

332

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paperlevel • 3d ago

Top 1% Commenter

This was a large scale operation: 594 BTC stolen at the same time. Largest holder lost 30 BTC.

<https://atlas21.com/594-bitcoin-drained-15-minutes-theft/>

AdEuphoric5133 • 3d ago • Edited 3d ago

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- Submissions that are mostly about some other cryptocurrency belong elsewhere. This subreddit is exclusive to Bitcoin.
- Promotion of client software which attempts to alter the Bitcoin protocol without overwhelming consensus is not permitted.
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R/BITCOIN RULES

- 1

No malicious content
- 2

No trolling
- 3

Do not promote altcoins
- 4

The primary topic is Bitcoin
- 5

Avoid repetition

of bitcoin before. All bitcoin thefts are generally someone giving away their seed from a stupid manipulation.

When I first read OP's post a few hours ago, I was like "dude probably just entered his seed wherever". But this time, the theft is very surgical. Someone exploited a flaw with coldcard. This is not your fault OP. They talk about you in the article. You will have to unite with the other victims and sue Coldcard to get compensated. I think it would be worth making a new post on this sub whose purpose is for other victims to make themselves known, so you can coordinate a group action





tubalubz • 3d ago
Top 1% Commenter

Coldcard could go out of business because of this... I sure as hell will never consider buying them. I agree, OP, you guys need justice.





reddit4485 • 3d ago
Top 1% Commenter

<https://blog.coinkite.com/coldcard-mk3-seed-generation-warning/>

This is the official blog of ColdCard. They just acknowledged this is a problem for the Mk3 model ColdCards and give recommendations on what to do next.





creative_usr_name • 3d ago

Will be interesting to see if this was just ineptitude, or intentionally implemented by an insider(s). Either way it's a terrible QA miss of one of the most important parts of the device.





Federal_Refrigerator • 3d ago

It's negligent if we are being honest

 3 more replies





Left_Entrepreneur918 • 3d ago
Top 1% Commenter

It could be larger, if other wallets used the same rng could this effect them? I made a 24

- 8 No faucets 
- 9 No URL shorteners or referrals 
- 10 Do not promote contentious hard forks 

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- [Release Announcement](#)
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PROJECTS



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1,224,324 members
-  [r/BitcoinMarkets](#)

s4_e20_spongebob • 3d ago

FYI even just saying that in a thread could be used by a bad actor to help target you. Idk that disclosing specific information like device model or your balance is ever really wise to do.

AdEuphoric5133 • 3d ago

Top 1% Commenter

Maybe recreate a seed with a dice. 99 throws of a dice give you the same entropy as 24 words. There are plenty of tutos out there on how to make a seed from dices

AdEuphoric5133 • 3d ago

Top 1% Commenter

Hopefully they will be held accountable for this. But I fear they might not

Rey_Mezcalero • 3d ago

Top 1% Commenter

They were supposed to be the ultimate cold storage. Wow. This is insane

omni_wisdumb • 3d ago

The issue with this space is that it's unregulated and very hard to actually track everything. Things being on a public block chain doesn't mean anything.

As far as we know. The company itself could have programmed in the vulnerability, taken \$40M worth of crypto. And they'll just file for bankruptcy or fall back on insurance or fall back on some fine print that says crypto is inherently risky and they're not responsible for anything.

Suing people in general is not easy, let alone in such a space.

AdEuphoric5133 • 3d ago • Edited 3d ago

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this will most certainly be long and hard, but that is his only shot at ever getting compensated.

The bad thing is that, even if he receives damages, this will amount to what the BTC were worth at the time of the theft (I guess). Even if the 0.79 BTC are worth 200k\$ when the trial is over, OP will only get about 50k USD



hetobe • 3d ago

The bad thing is that, even if he receives damages

I guarantee ColdCard has lawyers protecting them from any issues related to... let's just say... code exploits.

This is a very sad situation.



11 more replies



ryt3n • 3d ago

Reading on it a bit more now - looks like it was specific RNG generation that caused this? Sorry im a bit of a noob but goddamn that is wild... thinking of maybe picking up a trezor I dunno.



1 more reply



bittabet • 3d ago

In all honesty I'm not sure Coldcard has that kinda money. Hopefully the authorities can recover the funds if they're moved to a centralized exchange or something.



jlo18452 • 2d ago

The company has 1-10 employees 🤖🤖🤖 and 1-2m\$ revenue. Everyone sadly is fucked.



ryt3n • 3d ago

Bro wait, it's coldcard that's the problem!? Insane... I had a ledger and I bought a cold card a

+ 2 more replies
+ 4 more replies



ViperG • 3d ago

Someone was able to replicate the rng exploit on mk2/mk3:

<https://x.com/i/status/2082958675975553224>



AdEuphoric5133 • 3d ago

🏆 Top 1% Commenter

This confirms Coldcard's responsibility. When you sell devices aimed at storing bitcoins, you make sure your random number generator is state of the art random. Coldcard failed their users here and made them lose 38M\$. Victims have to unite and sue, otherwise, Coldcard will just deny, get away with it, and victims will not be compensated

As a matter of fact, Coldcard CEO is already trying to deny the company's responsibility



xirvin • 3d ago

cold card disclosed the vulnerability back in the day, if they disclosed the vulnerability but owners didn't update then its owners fault. At this point i want a full law enforcement involvement, OP please involve law enforcement. You never know if the funds can be recovered



BDCRA • 2d ago

When did they disclose the vulnerability? I did not see anything in the articles it all seemed like it was breaking news and not a known thing previously.

+ 1 more reply



kingkongbiingbong • 3d ago

Coldcard CEO is already trying to deny the company's responsibility

A tale as old as time

Also law enforcement should look into subpoenaing Anthropic/OpenAI for details of anyone who was working on such a hack. It feels likely to me that this was AI assisted, as this vulnerability has just been sitting here for 5 years and just happens to occur within weeks of us getting access to smarter models like Fable 5 which are known for their hacking prowess.

+ 1 more reply

 **mrzennie** • 3d ago

I just read Cold Card's slogan on their website: "Secure Your Bitcoin. Sleep Like a Baby."

 **PMmeuroneweirdtrick** • 3d ago

Babies wake up crying so that's accurate

 **AdEuphoric5133** • 3d ago

 Top 1% Commenter

Not sure OP's gonna sleep like a baby tonight 😂

 **s1amage OP** • 3d ago

 Top 1% Poster

I'm still here... take an upvote tho...

 **Total-Wave5026** • 3d ago

I'm so sorry for this bullshit OP.

 **mrzennie** • 3d ago

I feel for you, man! It definitely seems you're not alone though! Hopefully everyone who lost some Bitcoin will get compensated at least some of all of it back.

+ 1 more reply

 **Ambitious_Rope8881** • 3d ago

Jesus.

s1amage OP • 3d ago

**AdEuphoric5133** • 3d ago

Top 1% Commenter

But this is good news for you. If you were alone in this, you could already forget about these coins. But now, you have a real shot at getting compensated if you unite with other victims and sue coldcard together

**creative_usr_name** • 3d ago

The other big if is that coldcard must actually have assets to go after.

1 more reply

1 more reply

**ContentBlackberry0** • 3d ago

Good news is someone lost a few million and I'm sure has the cash to sue this horrible company

**OldHamburger7923** • 3d ago

Top 1% Commenter

i wouldn't assume that. a normal guy from last season low could have put their savings into btc. we'd need to check when they put the funds into the wallet to even guess.

4 more replies

1 more reply

**The_Bitcoin_Act** • 3d ago

Top 1% Commenter

Really sorry this happened to you. Losing that much is brutal, especially when you were careful with hardware wallets and air-gapping. I'm glad you're in a better headspace now and that it's not the end of the world for you. The fact that you're sharing the full timeline so others can learn from it is genuinely helpful. Take care of yourself, and I hope the remaining wallet stays safe.

**Generationhodl** • 3d ago

Top 1% Poster

<https://blog.coinkite.com/coldcard-mk3-seed-generation-warning/>



Too little too late



Strong_Judge_3730 • 3d ago

how long have they known about this and sat on their hands while their support gaslight their users?
That is the question...



Michichael • 3d ago

As an infosec guy, I wish and hope, but know it's not, a white hat that tried warning them via responsible disclosure and chose to sweep the funds to protect users.

We all know that we aren't that fortunate. My stomachs turned reading this. I can't image something like that happening to me - it'd destroy everything.



2 more replies



AdEuphoric5133 • 3d ago

🏆 Top 1% Commenter

<https://blog.coinkite.com/coldcard-mk3-seed-generation-warning/>

Coldcard acknowledging the issue be like : "Out of an abundance of caution"

When your clients just lost 594 BTC because of a mistake you made, acknowledging the issue is not "abundance of caution", it is the least you can do.

This company is a joke. Guys who use a Coldcard, make yourself a favor and buy a new hardware wallet



10 more replies



No_Position_8581 • 3d ago

multiple people on twitter reporting the same. This is the real deal. What firmware are you using? We need every detail



Left_Entrepreneur918 • 3d ago

🏆 Top 1% Commenter

What are they saying, like they all had mk4 cold card?



So far seems to be affecting mk3 only



Generationhodl • 3d ago

🏆 Top 1% Poster

some commented on X that MK4 also. but not sure if trustful information.



photoguy1978 • 3d ago

Yes still very unclear. There is information coming out but need to assess the math here and state space for this key search approach.
<https://x.com/LLFOURN/status/2082990000896147942>



1 more reply



1 more reply



Left_Entrepreneur918 • 3d ago

🏆 Top 1% Commenter

Damn I feel horrible for these people, all trusted self custody and went with the best brand for a really long time. *looking nervously at my 2020 ledger with outdated firmware...



goobly_goo • 3d ago

Yeah should I upgrade to the latest Trezor?! I wonder if this could happen to the old cold wallets?



Left_Entrepreneur918 • 3d ago

🏆 Top 1% Commenter

I got a Trezor 5 btc only and wanted to create one of their 20 word multi sig seeds but I'm afraid of moving my entire life savings. So it's been sitting in the box



2 more replies



1 more reply



2 more replies



Fair-Garlic8240 • 3d ago



spiderbait • 3d ago

Yep, who would trust this. If anything just leave it on Coinbase. All this effort by savvy people to protect their coins and they're still screwed.

Regular people could never handle this.



newtonreddits • 3d ago

Yeah coinbase is honestly safer for average joes



OverLulz • 3d ago

Or this concept of a bank. That stores money for people.



2 more replies



flannel_jackson • 3d ago

That's me. The average 40 year old guy with a house, 401k, bank account and credit cards. Never touched crypto. Saw people make a ton of money speculating on it but have never seen a reason to own or use it. 99.99% chance I'll never own any crypto.

Getting shit stolen sucks.



Klutzy-Peach5949 • 3d ago

I've certainly reduced how much crypto I have, just feels so uncomfortable keeping it safe, just selling for the headspace, and the volatility didn't help



s1amage OP • 3d ago

🏆 Top 1% Poster

I really thought it was 100% my fault. Now I know it's 99% my fault.



ArmchairCryptologist • 3d ago

Dice mixing and passphrases were always supposed to be optional hardening for the ultra-paranoid, as is evidenced by the fact that some notable Bitcoin devs are affected. If a hardware wallet marketed as the ultimate in self-custody ships with a broken entropy generator for *five years*, it's at most 1% your fault for only being *regular* paranoid.



master_of_buffets • 3d ago

Not 99%. This sub often laughed if someone suggested not trusting any device and using dice.



Generationhodl • 3d ago

🌟 Top 1% Poster

Can't be 99% your fault when you buy a product that worked well for long time and then get exploited..

This could have happened to other people too with other wallets if there is some kind of software / hardware bug to be exploited.

Don't be too hard to yourself , it hurts but you can only learn from it



poisito • 3d ago

Maybe not the best thing to mention at the moment, but if this is a legal ROTH IRA, you are going to get penalized by the IRS for taking money out, regardless if it was stolen.
Best of luck OP



StraightUp-Reviews • 3d ago

Ouch. Bro just got double fucked.



matrixmodifier • 3d ago

They still penalize if you've been robbed? My lord



poisito • 3d ago

They just know that you took money out of an account that is designed to not get money out ... it's on the terms of service per se that he signed when he opened the account ..

, because it's a Roth, he will need to pay any capital gains and 10% penalty



5 more replies



1 more reply



Fiach_Dubh • 3d ago

🌟 Top 1% Commenter

you only used sparrow on desktop right?

Did you roll dice when setting up the coldcard for extra entropy or just use the base entropy? if so, how many rolls did you do? less then 100?

Do you know the firmware versions you were using ?

I'm sorry this happened to you.

+ 1 more reply



Lanky_Assist_6317 • 3d ago

OK I have read everything and I have a question:
When you bought the original Coldcard, HOW did you generate the seed words? You mentioned in other comments there was no passphrase, but did you use dices or something similar to add random elements to the original seed which came with the device, or did you just take that for granted and used it anyway?

It seems to me that your original seeds were compromised from the start. Let's say some malicious Coldcard worker had access to the hardware wallets in the Coldcard production line or something like that, somehow managed to store a bunch of original seeds hoping buyers would use them as is and retire a couple of years later, raising no personal suspicion. It seems really likely, I have no idea how the production of these wallets work, but it could have some human processing in any way, which creates breaches like that, unfortunately.



s1amage OP • 3d ago

🏆 Top 1% Poster

It was generated by the coldcard. I followed BTCSessions's YouTube channel. I guess I should have used the dice method.



Lanky_Assist_6317 • 3d ago

So you didn't add any entropy whatsoever, either using dice or adding a passphrase. I strongly believe your original seed was compromised from the start through someone malicious with wallet access in the manufacturing chain. I see no other option.



s1amage OP • 3d ago

🏆 Top 1% Poster

Yea, my other wallet (from 2021) used the same but isn't compromised... yet...



bionicmixta • 3d ago

If you have another wallet generated by a coldcard please tell me you're taking steps to move it to something safer? If you think coldcard generates bad seeds and you think your other wallet may also be vulnerable, don't just sit and wait for that money to get stolen.

Obviously don't panic and do something stupid, but don't just leave it indefinitely until that one gets hacked as well.



5 more replies



OldHamburger7923 • 3d ago • Edited 3d ago

🏆 Top 1% Commenter

Look at the mk3 security advisory. It's about specific firmware. The RNG code isn't as random as it could be. Knowing that, an attacker can take their time (even over years) to run code to check potential addresses till they made a list large enough to sweep.

edit:

A flawed fallback RNG apparently derived randomness from a small or predictable device state, including a timer.

- The researchers narrowed that state to about 80,000 possibilities.
- They recreated the wallet's RNG process for each possibility.
- Each possibility produced a candidate 24-word phrase.
- They compared each candidate's resulting public wallet identifier, the xpub, against the known xpub. One candidate matched, revealing the private key and recovery phrase.
- 80,000-state timer range appears to come from a controlled reproduction where timing and device behavior were constrained. It does not prove that every affected wallet has exactly 80,000 possibilities.



1 more reply

**33halvings** • 3d ago

I remember coldcard being promoted as THE hardware wallet for Bitcoin-only people since it was also open-source etc. I'm glad I never bought and used it.

This is an absolute shitshow, might be the end of coldcard as a company.

**xiskghferx** • 3d ago

And all those people, who migrated from the Ledger to Coldcard, just because of new restore feature on Ledger...

We at least learned something - you cannot trust RNG in cold wallets. At least we should use additional BIP39 passphrase, generated elsewhere (e.g. in Bitwarden or Keepass).

But better, you should use multisig, using 2 different HW wallets...

Yes, I agree, with such mistakes, Bitcoin is never going to become mainstream.

**Raverrevolution** • 3d ago

LOL such mistakes only make it stronger. Bitcoin was never going to become mainstream when Mt Gox collapsed, but it did.

Most people will still need banks

**ryt3n** • 1d ago

Bro, this is so trippy man, I have a cold card in a box I bought in 2024 that I never had time to move to. I could have been affected. This is so surreal.

**OutrageousMango** • 3d ago

This is exactly why Bitcoin will never be mass adopted. No matter how safe you try to be, things like this continue to happen.



2 more replies

**NiagaraBTC** • 3d ago

📬 Top 1% Commenter



How certain are you that you were using a legitimate version of Sparrow?



s1amage OP • 3d ago

🏆 Top 1% Poster

It could be sparrow. I did have to update it...



Generationhodl • 3d ago

🏆 Top 1% Poster

on x another user said hes also affected with coldcard, but he did not use sparrow. So I think we might be able to say sparrow would not be the problem here.



Generationhodl • 3d ago

🏆 Top 1% Poster

did you download it from the official website? was it run on mobile phone or on a computer?

could be a malicious update or something like that, but I wonder myself because on X there is talk about other coldcard users affected... now is the question if the other people also used sparrow app and its just a coincidence that others also used coldcards....



4 more replies



9 more replies



5 more replies



thaneliness • 3d ago

So what exactly is the benefit of bitcoin versus investing in a ETF, where I know I'm 100% safe from bullshit like this? Honestly.



Abject-Stretch-1187 • 3d ago

You're not 100% safe with ETFs either because they still have centralized custodians so the custodians could be attacked as well.



OldHamburger7923 • 3d ago

🗨️ Top 1% Commenter

I read the prospectus on FBTC and IBIT and both said you are fucked if they get hacked.



coinbase have a larger target on their back because of the size of the assets they hold. your personal wallet isn't going to be large enough for anyone to focus on.



FitzwilliamTDarcy • 3d ago

Don't tell that to OP



1 more reply



1 more reply



Professional_Golf393 • 3d ago • Edited 2d ago

Coinkite filing for bankruptcy in 3..2..1

I'm so glad I bought the cold card mk1, it was so faulty it was basically unusable.. messaged support and their advice was to buy the mk2.

Since that day I've hated them.

Feel bad for everyone who lost money.. hopefully the thief slips up and gets caught, or returns funds, slim chance but possible.

I guess the lesson here is don't trust the entropy of any device, and don't store all your eggs in 1 basket



marvelish • 3d ago

Looks like it is probably an issue with mk2/mk3 seed generation:

<https://x.com/i/status/2082958675975553224>

Coinkite also just issued a statement they are investigating and any users that generated their seed this way should migrate.



Visual_Objective537 • 3d ago

<https://blog.coinkite.com/coldcard-mk3-seed-generation-warning/>

!! !! !! !! !! !! !! !!



s1amage OP • 3d ago

🌟 Top 1% Poster

Coinkite. My record from 2021 was still there. Let me see if I can get a screenshot

+ 3 more replies



flowstate_research • 3d ago

So this was an issue with the Coldcard random number generator?



-MOONMAN • 3d ago

How can your wallet from 2021 be fine and your new wallet which you entered your original seedphrase from 2021 be drained? It's the same wallet you're telling us.

+ 1 more reply



Open_Situation686 • 3d ago

This is why I won't make more than a small gamble on bitcoin.



imjsm006 • 3d ago

This is absolutely terrible but also strengthens my decision to have my bitcoin exposure in ETFs.



MicroneedlingAlone2 • 3d ago

Hey, it is not your fault. ColdCard fucked up. They just put out a blog post. Situation unfolding in realtime...

↑ 5 ↓ 🗨 Reply ...



pizzeriagio • 3d ago

What if someone hacked the official website, stole the buyers info and send the buyer a compromised wallet? You buy the wallet, the hacker steals your information, sends you the compromised wallet, he waits an year and steals all the funds on the wallets. Or maybe is just an insider that switched the regular coldcards with compromised ones.



👍 4 🗨️ Reply ...



downtherabbit • 3d ago

So never buy a cold card? Damn I thought they were one of the good ones.

⊖ ⬆️ 4 ⬇️ 🗨️ Reply ...



Saddath • 3d ago

Or maybe the learning is don't let someone or a device from someone calculate your seed phrase.

⬆️ 5 ⬇️ 🗨️ Reply ...

⊕ 2 more replies



ConsequenceFew6931 • 3d ago • Edited 3d ago

OP I ran your timeline through Opus 5. Here is what it had to say:

EDIT: removing my long post. It has been confirmed there was a breach on all coldcard mk3s due to weak entropy

⊖ ⬆️ 16 ⬇️ 🗨️ Reply ...



artilekt • 3d ago

It looks like this is a wide-scale attack though with many people affected, something that would not be isolated to his SD card.

⬆️ 26 ⬇️ 🗨️ Reply ...

⊕ 5 more replies

⊕ 7 more replies



Vegetable-Rabbit7503 • 3d ago

Do you think they would have taken your BTC if you had done everything the same but had a passphrase?

⬆️ 2 ⬇️ 🗨️ Reply ...



DifficultSquash1517 • 3d ago

Sorry this happened. I hope this inspires others to get out of self custody. Its so 2019

I know most people reading this think that it was this guy's fault or you're not that gullible or you're very careful etc etc. I don't know how you guys could sleep at night with lots of money sitting on these hardware wallets

Every time I plugged in to mine back in the day my heart would skip a beat before the balance would show up you know sometimes it gets delayed it almost gives me a heart



Create



Unless you're in it for the tech and you're only in it for the price action just go with the ETF so you can sleep at night. And you could write covered calls on your positions generating 1 to 2% every month which is insane



2



Reply



submarinefarm • 3d ago

Hard to read but you're not wrong. Reddit has been screaming 'buy a hardware wallet' for years and look what happened.



4



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